

In, on, and at

Learner workbook

Say where something is and when it happens.

Understand the distinction

Use in for an area or a period: in Seoul, in a box, in July. Use on for a surface or a particular day: on the table, on Tuesday. Use at for a point or an exact time: at the entrance, at 9:30.

These are starting patterns, not rules for every phrase. Learn common expressions as units: at home, at night, in the morning. In a building stresses being inside; at a building can name a meeting point.

Compare the patterns

IN

I live in Lima.

Lima is an area.

ON

The class is on Friday.

Friday is a particular day.

AT

Meet me at the entrance at six.

Both phrases identify a point.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. The call starts ____ 10:15.

2. The keys are ____ the kitchen table.

3. Correct this: We met in Monday.

Use it in your own life

Write an invitation with a place, a day, and a time.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. at

An exact time takes at.

2. on

The keys are resting on a surface.

3. We met on Monday.

Use on with a named day.

One possible response

Meet me at the library on Saturday at eleven.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-01.html